Option A Clean and Minimal

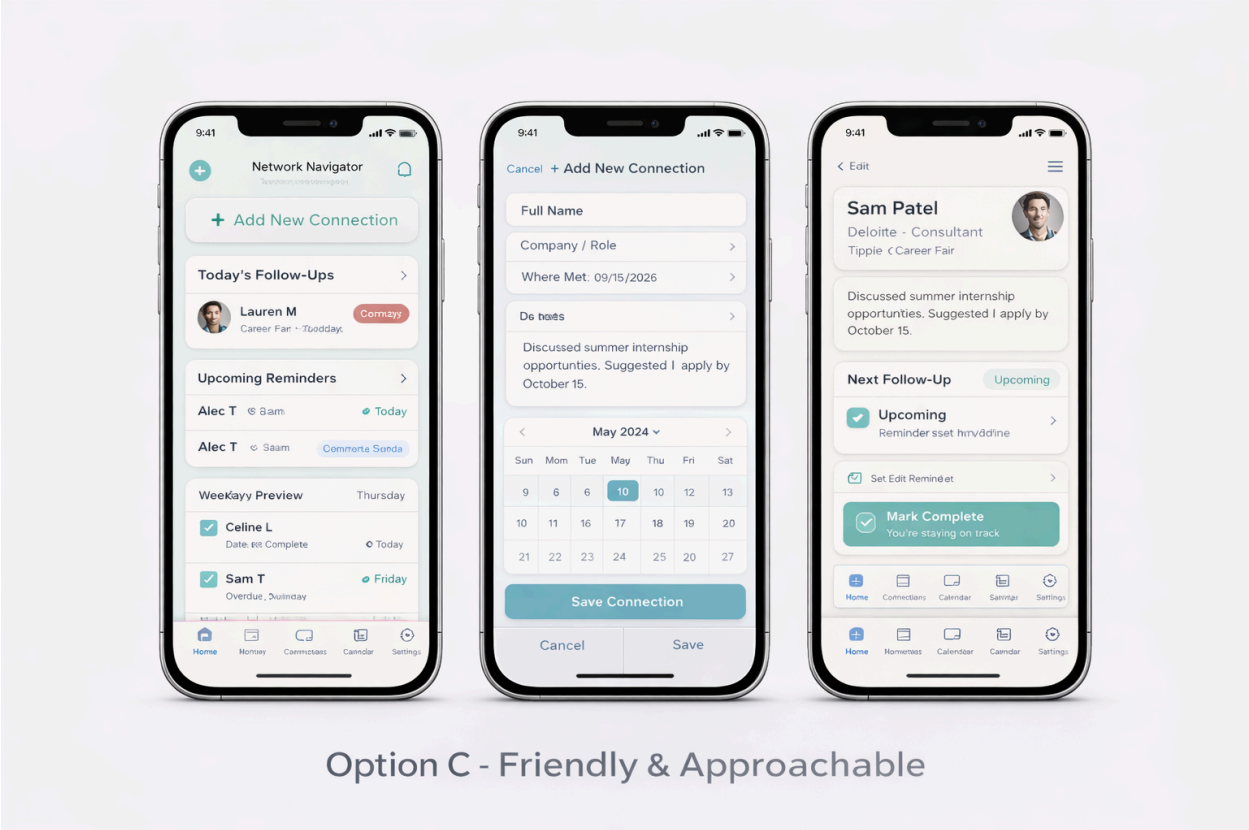
Option A is very strong from a usability perspective. The primary action Add New Connection is placed clearly at the top of the dashboard and stands out without being overwhelming. The layout uses simple cards and clear spacing, which makes it easy to scan sections like Today's Follow Ups and Upcoming Reminders. The labels are straightforward and consistent across the dashboard, add connection form, and connection detail screen. Because the design uses a light background with darker text, the contrast is strong and readable even at smaller sizes. The structure feels clean and predictable, which supports quick interaction.

One weakness of Option A is that it feels very neutral emotionally. While it is professional and organized, it does not actively reduce stress around overdue reminders. The design may feel similar to other productivity apps and might not stand out as something specifically built for networking. The main risk is not confusion, but that users might not feel especially motivated or emotionally supported when they fall behind on follow ups. However, from a clarity and accessibility standpoint, this option is very reliable and easy to use.

Option B Bold and Modern

Option B immediately draws attention to the primary action because of the strong contrast and bold styling. The Add New Connection button is very noticeable, and overdue reminders are impossible to miss. The dark background combined with bright accent colors makes sections visually distinct, which helps users quickly understand what needs attention. The circular progress indicators and highlighted cards create a strong sense of urgency and accountability. Text contrast is high, so readability is strong as long as the lighting is good.

However, this option could feel intense for some users. The bold red overdue sections and high contrast design might increase stress during busy recruiting periods. While this urgency could motivate action, it could also cause users to avoid opening the app if they feel behind. The heavier visual styling may slightly slow scanning compared to the minimal option. This design feels powerful and performance driven, but it carries more emotional risk for early career professionals who may already feel anxious about networking.



Option C - Friendly & Approachable

Option C Friendly and Approachable (What we picked)

Option C balances usability with a softer tone. The primary action is still clearly visible, but the rounded shapes and softer colors make the experience feel less pressured. The layout is organized and easy to scan, with clear labels and consistent structure across the dashboard, add connection form, and detail screen. As long as the text remains dark enough against the lighter backgrounds, readability and contrast remain accessible. The softer color palette makes overdue reminders noticeable without feeling aggressive.

The biggest strength of Option C is how well it fits the target user. Early career professionals often feel awkward or hesitant about delayed follow ups, and this design lowers the emotional barrier to re engaging. The risk would be making the interface too soft, which could reduce the sense of urgency or professionalism. If the contrast is not strong enough, smaller text could also become harder to read. Overall, this option feels supportive while still being functional, which aligns closely with the purpose of the product.